THE SESSION · LATE-SESSION READ

Tech Leads, *Oil Firms*

The Nasdaq rose 1.08% and the S&P 500 rose 0.59% as AI-related technology rebounded, while Brent rose 0.98% to $109.86 a barrel. Dividend Strategy +0.44% beat DVY and trailed SPY; Growth Portfolio +1.87% beat IUSG.

S&P 500 ▲ 0.59% NASDAQ ▲ 1.08% DOW ▲ 0.69% VIX ▼ 3.58% BRENT ▲ 0.98%

DIVIDEND STRATEGY — BEAT DVY · TRAILED SPY

+0.44% 1-DAY

FCI	+0.44%
DVY	−0.09%
SPY	+0.53%

YTD **+20.93%** vs DVY +15.64% · SPY +14.27%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO — ▲ BEAT IUSG

+1.87% 1-DAY

FCI	+1.87%
IUSG	+0.68%

YTD **+20.31%** vs IUSG +14.84%

THE SESSION

Stocks rose on Wednesday as a rebound in AI-related technology lifted the Nasdaq, while crude oil firmed on continued Middle East supply concerns. The Nasdaq rose 1.08% to 26,709, the S&P 500 rose 0.59% to 7,758 and the Dow rose 0.69% to 52,856; the VIX fell 3.58% to 16.69. Quarterly results from SpaceX that beat estimates, with its AI segment accounting for more than half of revenue, revived enthusiasm for the AI trade, and chipmakers led. The 10-year Treasury yield traded near 5.15% in the afternoon, against the official 5.12% on Tuesday. Brent rose 0.98% to $109.86 a barrel after settling at $108.79 on Tuesday, as unconfirmed reports of strikes on Saudi energy sites and attacks on Gulf shipping kept supply risk in focus, even as mediation efforts capped the intraday high. IBIT rose 2.42% and ETHA rose 2.47%.

The Dividend Strategy rose 0.44%, ahead of DVY's 0.09% decline by 0.53 point and behind SPY's 0.53% gain by 0.09 point, with seventeen of twenty-five holdings higher and eight lower. Constellation Energy rose 4.60% and added about 0.24 point, while Analog Devices, S&P Global, Broadcom and Caterpillar each added about 0.07 point. Stryker fell 2.26% and subtracted about 0.13 point, Abbott fell 1.84% and subtracted about 0.07 point after its third-quarter report, and Waste Management fell 0.93%, subtracting about 0.06 point. Abbott reported adjusted earnings of $1.42 per share on comparable sales growth of 7.0%, narrowed its full-year adjusted earnings range to $5.50–$5.55 and guided to comparable sales growth of about 6.0%.

Rebounds led by a single theme can fade as quickly as they build, and a firm oil price keeps rate and inflation questions open; owning cash-generative businesses across both sleeves tends to reduce erosion when leadership rotates. ***Think Like an Owner.***

The Growth Portfolio rose 1.87%, ahead of IUSG's 0.68% gain by 1.19 points, with twenty-one of twenty-five holdings higher and four lower. Vistra rose 3.91% and added about 0.24 point, Credo rose 6.28% and added about 0.24 point, and ServiceNow rose 2.41%, adding about 0.21 point. Full Truck Alliance fell 3.94% and subtracted about 0.12 point, with Harmony Biosciences subtracting about 0.04 point and CNX Resources about 0.03 point. On the year, the Dividend Strategy stands at +20.93% against DVY's +15.64%, a +5.29-point spread, with SPY at +14.27%; the Growth Portfolio stands at +20.31% against IUSG's +14.84%, a +5.47-point spread.

FCI HOLDINGS · NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

CRDO +6.28% GROWTH
Rose to $182.28 as semiconductor names rebounded.

CEG +4.60% DIVIDEND
Rose to $270.74 without a company-specific catalyst identified.

GNRC +4.42% GROWTH
Rose to $203.20 without a company-specific catalyst identified.

VRT +4.29% GROWTH
Rose to $212.30 without a company-specific catalyst identified.

DECLINERS

YMM −3.94% GROWTH
Fell to $8.50 without a company-specific catalyst identified.

SYK −2.26% DIVIDEND
Fell to $297.53 without a company-specific catalyst identified.

ABT −1.84% DIVIDEND
Fell to $100.56 after third-quarter adjusted earnings of $1.42 per share and a full-year comparable sales outlook of about 6.0%.

NTR −1.32% DIVIDEND
Fell to $68.12 without a company-specific catalyst identified.

YEAR-TO-DATE STANDING

DIVIDEND STRATEGY
+20.93%
vs DVY +15.64% / SPY +14.27%
Spread vs DVY **+5.29 pts**

GROWTH PORTFOLIO
+20.31%
vs IUSG +14.84%
Spread vs IUSG **+5.47 pts**

SOURCES

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4. Abbott Laboratories, "Abbott Reports Third-Quarter 2026 Results and Reaffirms Full-Year EPS Guidance," Oct. 21, 2026.
5. Market data: Financial Modeling Prep. Strategy returns: Paradiem FCI portfolio records.